Qwiklabs guidelines and troubleshooting steps

Qwiklabs has updated their terms of services to include an ***age requirement of 18+ to use the platform****, in order to comply with regulations in the US and EU. Learners without access to Qwiklabs are still able to complete the certification and gain the badge by reviewing the Qwiklab readings that follow each lab. These readings are essential to understanding the certificate's concepts and preparing learners for graded assessments.*

Throughout this certificate, you will use Qwiklabs through Coursera to complete hands-on activities that include writing Python scripts, debugging Python scripts, using GitHub, and automating Cloud deployment. Qwiklabs is an online lab tool that creates simulated Windows and Linux OS environments, allowing you to use both Linux and Windows operating systems as if they were installed on your local machine. When you access labs through Coursera you will be given the software and OS setup needed to complete the lab.

In this reading, you'll find guidelines and demos that will help you use Qwiklabs successfully. Additionally, you'll examine some troubleshooting steps you can take if you encounter any difficulties using Qwiklabs on your computer. Finally, we'll provide resources you can access if you encounter any issues you cannot resolve on your own.

How to use Qwiklabs successfully

Follow the guidelines below whenever you begin a lab.

1. **Access the lab directly through Coursera** (not through the Qwiklabs catalog).
2. **Agree to the Coursera honor code**, and click "**Launch App**."
3. **Sign in.** If this is your first time using Qwiklabs, you will be prompted to either create an account or sign in with Google. Once you've completed this step, you will not have to do this for subsequent labs.
4. Select the "**Start Lab**" button to begin the lab.

5. **Allow time for the lab to load**. Qwiklabs are launched in an interactive Cloud environment and take some time to load, often several minutes. Additionally, you may experience some delays when the Linux and Windows simulated environments boot up.

6. **Notice the time allotted for the lab**. Unless stated otherwise, you will have 90 minutes to complete each Qwiklabs assignment. **If you don't finish the lab in the allotted time, you'll need to restart the lab from the beginning.**

1. **Note:** Qwiklabs cannot save your work because each time you begin a lab, temporary credentials are created for you to connect to the lab. These credentials expire at the end of the lab assignment.

7. **Allow the Qwiklab and browser read access to your computer's clipboard**, if you feel comfortable doing so. This will allow you to copy and paste commands from the lab into the virtual environment you're using within Qwiklabs.

8. **Do not select the "End Lab" button until you've finished each step and your lab has been running for at least 5 minutes**. Otherwise, your lab might not be marked as complete.
9. **Use the right browser.** Make sure your internet browser is up-to-date. Qwiklabs requires the latest version of Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, Safari, or Microsoft Edge. If your browser is outdated or not supported by Qwiklabs, you may encounter a problem. If your browser is up to date and you are using one of the browsers listed above and still encountering problems try restarting your browser or clearing your browser's cache and cookies. You can also use incognito mode which prevents your browser from storing cookies and other temporary data.

1. **Note:** The Qwiklabs user interface works best with Google Chrome.

10. **Use a stable internet connection.** If you are experiencing problems starting or completing Qwiklabs your internet connection may be too slow or unreliable. Some signs of an unstable internet connection may be freezing labs, difficulty connecting to virtual machines, or the inability to type or enter commands within the lab environment.

1. **Pro tip:** If you are unable to complete a Qwiklab on one device, try using another device.

Accessing a lab's virtual machine (VM)

To use the Qwiklabs in this certificate program, you'll need to access each lab's virtual machine. This process depends on your computer's operating system. The details needed to access a lab's VM are included in each lab's instructions on the Qwiklabs platform. Additionally, to view a demonstration, select the link for the operating system of the machine you are currently using from the following list. Note that these video resources do not have a voiceover or any audio:

- For Windows users
- For Mac users
- For Linux users
- For Chrome OS users

Troubleshooting steps

If you encounter a problem or error message while completing a lab, make sure you've followed the steps and guidelines above. If you have followed all the guidelines, try the troubleshooting steps below.

1. Make sure you are using the latest version of a supported browser: Google Chrome, Firefox, Safari, or Microsoft Edge.
2. Restart your browser and clear your browser's cache and cookies. You can also use incognito mode.
3. Check your internet connection and make sure it is stable. You can try restarting your router and modem to regain a stable connection.
4. Try restarting Qwiklabs.
5. If you receive a message stating that you have exceeded the quota for a Qwiklab, submit this form to Qwiklabs support for assistance. When you submit the form:

1. Use the email address you use to access Coursera.
2. Provide the link to the lab and the title of the course.

3. Ask the support agent to reset the quota so you can retake the lab and complete the Google IT Automation Certificate.

What to do if you’re stuck

If problems persist after you’ve tried troubleshooting on your own, go to the Qwiklabs support page for more guidance. Alternatively, reach out to the Qwiklabs support team through the chat support option in the lab’s ‘help’ menu or contact Qwiklabs support through this link.